



Industry News

Android's growth in 2009 slated to outpace all other mobile OSs

According to industry analysts, Strategic Analytics, globally, Android smartphone shipments will grow 900 per cent in 2009. The market watchers believe that healthy support from operators, vendors and developers will drive adoption. The



same analysts claim that Apple's iPhone OS will be the next fastest-growing smartphone operating system in 2009, with a 79 per cent growth rate.

Added Neil Mawston, director, Strategic Analytics, "Android has fast been winning healthy support

amongst operators, vendors and developers. A relatively low-cost licensing model, its semi-open-source structure and Google's support for cloud services have encouraged companies such as HTC, Motorola, Samsung, T Mobile, Vodafone and others to support the Android operating system. Android is now in a good position to become a top-tier player in smartphones over the next two to three years."

The 900 per cent figure has raised eyebrows, since as of Q2, only a million Android-powered handsets have been shipped. It would require over another 5 million handsets to reach the market, to qualify for the 900 per cent claim. IDC pegs Android's growth rate at a more realistic 420 per cent. And backs the Blackberry OS for second place, rather than the iPhone OS.

Intel, Novell to drive Moblin adoption

Intel and Novell have announced broad efforts to closely collaborate and encourage OEMs and ODMs (original design manufacturers) to adopt Moblin, an optimised open source Linux software platform to enable rich Internet experiences on Intel Atom processor-based netbooks and other mobile systems. Intel and Novell signed an agreement outlining their plans for collaboration. Novell also announced it will create a Moblin-based product for netbooks that it will market to a wide range of OEMs and ODMs. Additionally, Novell will establish Novell Open Labs in Taiwan to foster the adoption of Moblin and will work with the Taiwan Moblin Enabling Center (MEC), a joint effort of Intel and the Taiwan Institute for Information Industry, to validate designs for Moblin compliance.

The third Blender movie in the pipeline

Blender's third short 3D animation film will be based on the work of renowned author Martin Lodewijk. The 3D film—financed via the Internet and created with open source software—will be distributed freely. Producer Ton Roosendaal from the Netherlands-based Blender Institute is working with comic book author

Martin Lodewijk on Blender's third short 3D animation movie. The film, with working title 'Durian', will be released and distributed as open content. Users and sponsors of the 3D program Blender will finance this project, with the main goal to further develop publicly available advanced 3D animation techniques. The production will start in September, and is expected to get a worldwide premiere in April 2010. For more information, go to: durian.blender.org

The Blender Institute is the studio spin-off of the Blender Foundation, which organises and facilitates online projects to further develop the open source Blender 3D creation suite. With over 3.5 million downloads annually, Blender now is one of the most popular programs worldwide for 3D artists and animators.



Sun reports surge in adoption of the Sun Unified Storage Family

Sun has announced that hundreds of customers across a range of industries have purchased high-performance, eco-efficient Flash-enabled Sun Storage 7000 Systems to store more than 17 petabytes of data, making it the fastest ramping new product in Sun's storage portfolio ever. Continuing to add innovation to its Open Storage portfolio and Open Network Systems strategy, Sun also announced hardware capacity enhancements to the Sun Unified Storage family and an upgrade to its Analytics software, which ships with the Sun Storage 7000 line and gives storage administrators unparalleled insight into their storage systems. For a demo of the enhanced Sun Unified Storage family or to download software, you can go to www.sun.com/unifiedstorage.